

Participant Worksheet

Communicating Up: Building Confidence Across Generations

Program	New Intern Onboarding
Workshop	Communication Challenge Lab
Duration	90 minutes
Name	
Date	

How to Use This Worksheet

Use this worksheet during the workshop to capture your ideas, practice messages, and 30-day communication commitment. There are no perfect answers. Focus on clarity, respect, and ownership.

1. Communication Reality Check

What feels hardest when communicating with senior managers or leaders? Circle one or add your own.

- A. I do not know how formal I should be.
- B. I worry my question sounds obvious.
- C. I do not know how much detail to include.
- D. I feel nervous speaking in meetings.
- E. I am not sure how to respond to feedback.
- Other: _____

One situation where I want to communicate more confidently:

2. Manager Lens Scenario

Scenario: You are assigned to support a safety reporting project. Your manager asks for a draft summary by Thursday. On Wednesday afternoon, you realize you are unsure which data source to use. You send this message:

"Hi, I'm confused about the data. Can you help?"

Question	Your Notes
What is unclear about this message?	
What would the manager still need to know?	
How could this message be improved?	

3. The CLEAR Framework

Letter	Meaning	Prompt
C	Context	What is the situation?
L	Lead with the point	What is the main message or request?
E	Explain briefly	What does the manager need to know?
A	Ask or action	What do you need, or what will you do next?
R	Recap next step	Confirm deadline, owner, or follow-up.

Practice Scenario: Your manager asked you to review a vendor proposal. You completed the review, but you found two pricing items that may need clarification before the team meeting tomorrow.

CLEAR Element	Draft Your Manager-Ready Update
Context	

Lead with the point	
Explain briefly	
Ask or action	
Recap next step	

Final version after partner feedback:

4. Message Makeover Challenge

Rewrite your assigned message for a senior manager or project lead. Use the scorecard to check your work.

Original Message	Improved Version
Scorecard Criteria	Yes / Not Yet
Is the purpose clear?	
Is the tone professional?	
Is the request specific?	
Is the message concise?	
Is there a next step?	

5. Ask Better Questions

Scenario: Your manager says, “Can you put together a short update for next week’s project review?” You are not sure what “short update” means, who the audience is, or what format your manager expects.

Question Purpose	Question I Could Ask
Clarify audience	
Clarify format	
Clarify scope	
Clarify deadline	
Confirm next step	

My strongest clarifying question:

6. Feedback and Follow-Up

Scenario: Your manager says, “This update has useful information, but it is too detailed for the leadership meeting. Please make it shorter and focus on the key decision points.”

Choose the strongest response:

- A. “Oh, sorry. I didn’t know. I’ll fix it.”
- B. “I included the details because I thought they were important.”
- C. “Thank you. I’ll revise it to focus on the key decision points. Could you confirm if you want it limited to one page?”
- D. “Okay.”

Why is the strongest response effective?

My feedback sentence starter:

7. 30-Day Communication Commitment

Choose one specific communication behavior you will practice during your internship.

Prompt	My Commitment
One communication habit I want to improve	
One situation where I will use CLEAR	
One question I will ask my manager to clarify expectations	
One action I will take after receiving feedback	

My 30-day commitment statement:
